

Business and Utility

Despite the late 1980s recession, the business aircraft category thrived through the 1990s. Most aircraft represented progressive development from 1970s designs and included every type from relatively inexpensive single-engined aircraft to triple-engined ones. Some machines boasted long ranges, others high cruise altitude; some featured internal luxury, others, fuel economy. Similarly targeted aircraft served farmers and high-altitude telecommunications.



△ Air Tractor AT-502 1990

Origin USA

Engine 680hp Pratt & Whitney Canada PT-6A turboprop

Top speed 140 mph (225 km/h)

The 500-gallon (1,893-liter) AT-502 was the most popular of Leland Snow's big, powerful crop sprayer designs—others carried up to 800 gallons (3,028 liters). First flown in 1986, it is still in production with more than 600 built.



△ Bombardier Learjet 60 1991

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 4,600 lb (2,087 kg) thrust Pratt & Whitney Canada PW305A turbofan

Top speed 536 mph (863 km/h)

Bill Lear's very successful business jet family began in the 1960s and was bought by Bombardier in 1990. The 60 added improved aerodynamics and new engines to the 55; 314 were built.

▷ Cessna 525 CitationJet I 1991

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 1,900 lb (862 kg) thrust Williams FJ44 turbofan

Top speed 447 mph (719 km/h)

This light corporate jet was designed to carry six, or up to nine, passengers in luxurious seating. It was intended for single pilot operation, and had sophisticated avionics; developed versions remain in production.



△ Cessna Citation VII 1991

Origin USA

Engine 2 x Garrett TFE731-4R turbofan

Top speed 552 mph (888 km/h)

Reacting to past snubs of "Slowtations," the VII's powerful engines gave it a maximum cruise speed well above rival Learjets. It was based on the Citation III of the late 1970s; 119 were sold.



△ Cessna Citation X 1993

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 6,442 lb (2,922 kg) thrust Rolls-Royce AE 3007C turbofan

Top speed 700 mph (1,127 km/h)

Although based on the Citation VII, the X had new wing and cabin design, and two powerful Rolls-Royce engines that made it the fastest business jet in the world; over 330 have been sold.



△ Cessna 560 Citation Excel 1996

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 3,952 lb (1,793 kg) thrust Pratt & Whitney Canada PW545 turbofan

Top speed 506 mph (814 km/h)

A more spacious business jet with room to stand upright and space for up to ten passengers, although typically laid out for six to eight, the Excel sold extremely well and had a very good safety record.



▷ Piaggio P180 Avanti 1990

Origin Italy

Engine 2 x 850hp Pratt & Whitney Canada PT-6A-66 turboprop

Top speed 458 mph (737 km/h)

This unconventional design, with small front wings and conventional tailplane, allowed the main wings and "pusher" turboprops to be mounted far back, giving the Avanti a very quiet cabin and good fuel economy.